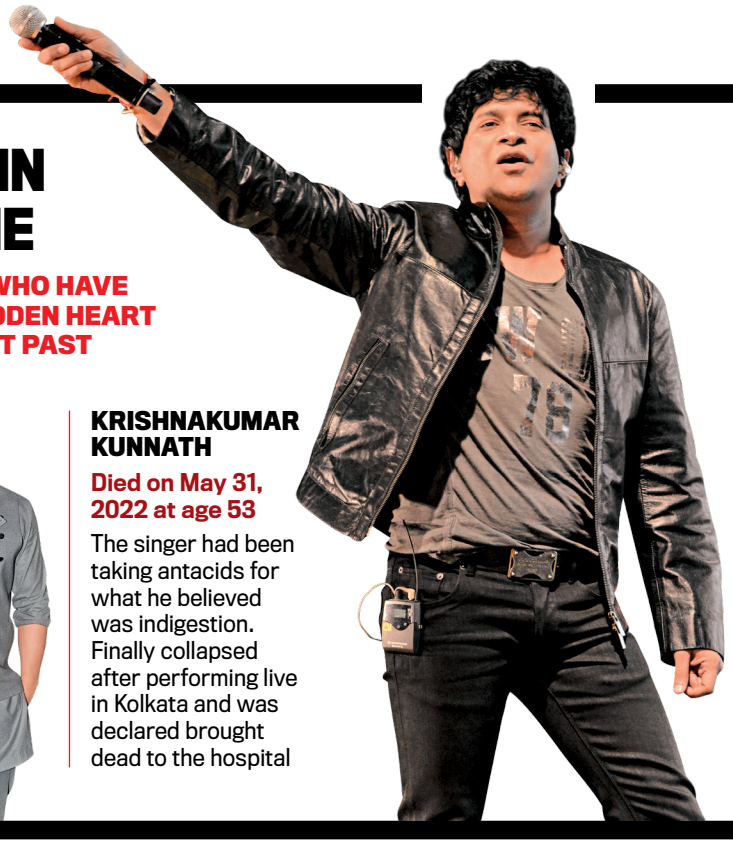
SNATCHED IN THEIR PRIME

YOUNG CELEBRITIES WHO HAVE SUCCUMBED TO A SUDDEN HEART ATTACK IN THE RECENT PAST



SIDHARTH SHUKLA

Died on Sept. 2, 2021 at age 40

The actor had complained of chest pain and died of a heart attack overnight



KRISHNAKUMAR KUNNATH

Died on May 31, 2022 at age 53

The singer had been taking antacids for what he believed was indigestion. Finally collapsed after performing live in Kolkata and was declared brought dead to the hospital

RAJ KAUSHAL

Died on June 30, 2021 at age 49

The filmmaker had reported feeling uneasy and died of a cardiac arrest en route to the hospital



of interventional cardiology at Fortis Hospital on Bannerghatta Road in Bengaluru. "If you have had health problems for 20-30 years, then the damage is already done," he adds. Indeed, a trial published in 2014 in the *Journal of Endocrinology and Metabolism* found that 46 per cent of those with Type 2 diabetes were under 40, and could have prevented or delayed their condition simply by managing their lifestyles.

THE STRESS FACTOR

Stress is another big culprit in precipitating heart attacks. In February 2021, a study from Linköping University in Sweden found that the stress hormone cortisol had increased significantly in the 174 people it studied in the months prior to heart attacks. "While stress can directly increase inflammation in your body, induce high blood pressure, it can also impact you indirectly," says Dr Vinay Kumar Bahl, principal director of cardiac sciences at Max Healthcare and the former head of cardiology at AIIMS. Chronic stress leads people to worry more, sleep badly, exercise less and binge on unhealthy 'feelgood' food. The American Heart Association in a September 2021 study found that those with high stress were likely to develop hypertension and cardiac issues in the next 6-7 years if left unmanaged.



"Cardiac stents have progressed immensely in the past 30 years. Not only are they safer to deploy but are also far more effective"

DR ASHOK SETH
Chairman, Fortis Escorts Heart Institute, Delhi

The curious case of brothers Ishaan and Shivansh Srivastava illustrates this. Aged 48 and 52, respectively, the duo runs a packaging manufacturing company in Mumbai. While Ishaan had all the risk factors for heart disease—he smokes, drinks and is slightly overweight—it was Shivansh who was diagnosed with heart problems in 2021. Doctors said his risk factors arose from his incredibly high intake of salt and sugar on account of constant stress eating late at night. He also led an extremely sedentary lifestyle, clocking no more than 500 steps a day. "I never got fat," he says, "because I ate only one meal. But that one meal was mostly junk. My brother goes every morning